



VIJAYANAGAR ART

Art and architecture flourished during the reign of Vijayanagar kings. Spectacular temples were built out of stone and decorated with elaborate murals and carvings. This mural covers the walls and ceilings of the entrance hall at the Veerabhadra Temple in Lepakshi (modern-day Andhra Pradesh).



◀ QUTB MINAR

The formerly enslaved soldier Qutb al-Din Aibak rose through the ranks of the military of the Ghori Dynasty to become the first ruler of the Delhi Sultanate in 1206. To commemorate his victories, he ordered the building of the sandstone Qutb Minar minaret (left), which still towers over South Delhi.

HAMPI ▶

The Vijayanagar Empire was founded by two Hindu brothers, who set up a new capital called Vijayanagara (modern-day Hampi). It was filled with exquisite monuments, such as this stone chariot, and by 1500 it had become the world's second-largest city after Beijing.



THE DELHI SULTANATE

1206–1290 CE

The former general Qutb al-Din Aibak establishes the Mamluk Dynasty, the first dynasty to rule over the Delhi Sultanate.

1290–1320 CE

The Khaliji Dynasty comes to power after a revolution, and extends the territory under the Delhi Sultanate's control to cover much of western India.

1320–1451 CE

The Delhi Sultanate reaches the peak of its power under the Tughlaq Dynasty (1320–1413), which is succeeded by the Sayyid Dynasty (1414–1451).

1451–1526 CE

The Lodi Dynasty briefly revives the Delhi Sultanate's power, but after a series of rebellions it falls to Mughal forces in 1526.